

4. Submissions not meeting minimum time requirement

The combined performance time of both performances must be at least four minutes.

Students submitting combined performances of less than four minutes in length should be marked against the assessment criteria on the following pages.

Centres will be required to notify us of any students who do not meet the minimum time requirement of four minutes.

For performances that do not meet the minimum time requirement, the total performance mark will be reduced proportionally according to how many seconds the combined performance time is less than four minutes. This will be applied by Pearson during the moderation process. Please see *Appendix 9: Mark penalty tables for assessments that do not meet the minimum assessment time*.

If during the moderation process inaccuracies in the performance times are discovered, the moderator may request the rest of the cohort to verify the correct timings.

Failure to accurately record the performance times may result in staff/centre malpractice. For further information about this, please see the *Administration and general information* section in this specification.

Gaps between pieces and tuning **do not** count towards the performance time.

If students wish to re-record a performance before submission, they must re-record the whole performance (either solo or ensemble), and not just part of it. The teacher must be present during the recordings.

Marking, standardisation and moderation

Teachers should mark the performances using the assessment criteria on the following pages. Teachers may annotate students' work but should also include any comments on the *Performance authentication sheet* to justify the marks awarded. Only the pieces performed are to be assessed. The score and/or written commentaries are not assessed and receive no marks.

Additional marks will also be applied to each performance based on the difficulty of the piece performed. Teachers should decide on the difficulty of the piece played and follow the instructions on page 19 for applying the difficulty levels grid to each solo and ensemble performance.

Where marking has been carried out by more than one teacher in a centre, there must be a process of internal standardisation carried out to ensure that there is a consistent application of the assessment criteria.

Marks awarded by the centre will be subject to external moderation by Pearson. Moderation will ensure consistency with national standards. Pearson will notify centres of the students whose work has been selected for moderation. This sample will take cohort size into account.

If the moderation indicates that centre assessment does not reflect national standards, an adjustment will be made to students' final marks to compensate.

For up-to-date advice on teacher involvement and administration of non-examination assessments, please refer to the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) document *Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments (new GCE and GCSE specifications)* available on the JCQ website: www.jcq.org.uk

Performance assessment criteria

Teachers must mark students' performances using the three assessment criteria grids on the following pages to give a mark out of 24, and there are also a further 6 marks available for the difficulty of the piece (totalling 30 marks per piece).

For the performing component, students can use any instrument for their solo and ensemble performances, including those that make use of music technology (e.g. electric guitar).

Performance is assessed against AO1: Perform with technical control, expression and interpretation.

Performance assessment grid 1: Technical control – Technique assesses the students' technical control of the instrument.

Performance assessment grid 2: Expression and interpretation assesses the students' ability to communicate a musically convincing performance.

Performance assessment grid 3: Technical control (accuracy) and expression and interpretation (fluency) assesses the students' ability to use technical control to play the piece accurately, and their ability to use expression and interpretation to play the piece fluently.

These criteria have been developed to assess students' skills in technical control, expression, and interpretation. They are to be used to assess both their solo and ensemble performances. All performances are able to be assessed using the criteria on the following pages, including realising music using technology. For ensemble performances, students are to be assessed on their role throughout the performance and grids 2 and 3 have criteria in italics on which ensemble performances must be assessed.

Where the word 'instrument' is mentioned this includes voice.

For the performance being assessed, teachers should use their professional judgement to establish in which level of quality of the music performed is. Where instruments other than those listed in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 1/Level 2 GCSE (9–1) in Music Difficulty levels booklet* are presented (such as non-GME instruments, e.g. sitar) the performance assessment criteria should be applied at a comparable level of demand with GME instruments.

The marks for each performance will be out a total of 30 marks and will carry equal weighting as part of this component, even if they are of different lengths.

Teachers should decide on the difficulty of the pieces performed and follow the instructions on pages 24–26 for applying the difficulty levels grid to each solo and ensemble performance.

Teachers should mark the performances against each of the three grids and then apply the difficulty levels grid in order to get a total mark out of 30 for each performance (solo and ensemble). The totals from each (solo out of 30 and ensemble out of 30) should be added together to give the total marks for this component out of 60.

Performance assessment grid 1: Technical control – Technique

In this grid, marks are awarded for the technical control of the instrument, for example, coordination between the hands, or of the bow/fingers; breath control; diction, pedalling; registration; intonation; tone quality; use of filters and effects and control of musical sources.

This will include making use of musical elements as appropriate to the requirements of the instrument(s) and piece performed. For ensemble performances, this grid assesses only the student's individual control of their instrument.

For performances up to difficulty level 2 please see the wording in italics in the grid below.

Level	Mark	Technique
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–2	• The performance overall demonstrates poor technical control, as heard in poor coordination, breath control, diction, and/or pedalling. • The demands of the music are beyond the current ability of the performer. • The handling of sonority is poor, as heard in a dull, thin, coarse tone quality across the range and/or poor intonation throughout and/or poor use of filters and effects. If the difficulty of the music performed is pre-difficulty level 1 the mark awarded in this grid cannot exceed this level.
Level 2	3–4	• The performance demonstrates limited technical control, as heard in limited coordination, breath control, diction, and/or pedalling. • There are a few places where the demands of the music are beyond the current ability of the performer. • The handling of sonority is limited, as heard in a dull, thin, coarse tone quality in places and/or limited intonation in places and/or limited use of filters and effects. If the difficulty of the music performed is at difficulty level 1 the mark awarded in this grid cannot exceed this level.

Level	Mark	Technique
Level 3	5–6	• The performance demonstrates basic technical control, as heard in basic coordination, breath control, diction, and/or pedalling. • There are one or two moments where the demands of the piece are beyond the current ability of the performer. • The handling of sonority is good, as heard in consistently good tone quality except at the extremities of the pitch range or at moments of technical difficulty and/or good intonation and/or good use of filters and effects. If the difficulty of the music performed is at difficulty level 2 the mark awarded in this grid cannot exceed this level.
Level 4	7–8	• The performance demonstrates convincing technical control, as heard in convincing coordination, breath control, diction, and/or pedalling. • The demands of the music are within the ability of the performer. • The handling of sonority is convincing, as heard in very good tone quality across the pitch range (satisfying, interesting and even as the music demands), including, where appropriate, very good and sensitive tonal contrast throughout and/or very good intonation and/or very good use of filters and effects.

Performance assessment grid 2: Expression and interpretation

In this grid, marks are awarded for communicating a musically convincing performance through the use of musical elements as appropriate to the piece performed. The text in italics is to be applied to ensemble performances.

Level	Mark	Expression and interpretation
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–2	• Inappropriate or inconsistent tempo throughout. • Little or no appropriate dynamic contrast, and little or no attention given to phrasing and articulation. • The performance communicates poorly. • In ensemble performances there is little awareness of balance.
Level 2	3–4	• An unsuitable or inconsistent tempo in places. • Limited use of dynamics, phrasing and articulation to shape the performance. • The performance struggles to communicate and may sound mechanical. • In ensemble performances there is occasional awareness of balance.
Level 3	5–6	• The use of tempo is usually appropriate and consistent • Some use of dynamics, phrasing and articulation to shape the performance, but several opportunities, notated or otherwise, are missed • The performance demonstrates some involvement with the music. • In ensemble performances there is a good awareness of balance throughout
Level 4	7–8	• The use of tempo is appropriate and consistent throughout. • Appropriate use of dynamics, phrasing and articulation to shape the performance. • The performance communicates very well, with no more than one or two less successful moments. • In ensemble performances there is excellent awareness of balance throughout.

Performance assessment grid 3: Technical control (accuracy) and expression and interpretation (fluency)

In this grid, marks are awarded for the technical control (accuracy), and the expression and interpretation (fluency) of the performance, as appropriate to the chosen instrument(s) and piece, including making use of musical elements as appropriate. The text in *italics* is to be applied to improvised and/or ensemble performances as appropriate.

Level	Mark	Accuracy and fluency
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–2	• The performance has several noticeable/obtrusive errors in pitch and/or rhythm that impact on its success overall. • Coherence and fluency are frequently compromised by breakdowns and/or omissions. • Improvised performances demonstrate little accuracy when performing the stimulus and little development of this material. The improvisation will lack coherence and contrast. • In ensemble performances there is evidence of difficulty in reacting and adjusting to other parts.
Level 2	3–4	• The performance has noticeable/obtrusive errors or omissions in pitch and/or rhythm, that have little or no impact on its success overall. • There are moments where coherence is lost, with some hesitation and/or omission, but the performance is still reasonably fluent for the majority of piece. • Improvised performances demonstrate some accuracy when performing the stimulus, with limited development of the stimulus. The improvisation sounds repetitive, predictable and/or formulaic. • In ensemble performances there is occasional difficulty in reacting and adjusting to other parts.

Level	Mark	Accuracy and fluency
Level 3	5–6	• The performance has no more than one or two noticeable/obtrusive errors or omissions in pitch and/or rhythm, that have minimal impact on its success overall. • The performance is mostly coherent and fluent despite the occasional hesitation and/or omission. • Improvised performances demonstrate a mostly accurate performance and show some development of the stimulus. The improvisation attempts to create variety but may rely heavily on repetition, and be predictable and/or formulaic in places. • In ensemble performances there is generally good reaction and, where appropriate, adjustment to other parts.
Level 4	7–8	• The performance is largely accurate with no more than one or two minor errors in pitch and/or rhythm. These errors have no impact on its success overall. • The performance is coherent and fluent despite the occasional slight hesitation and/or omission • Improvised performances demonstrate an accurate performance of the stimulus, and produce an interesting realisation of the stimulus. The improvisation is coherent, well balanced and effective throughout. • In ensemble performances a consistently responsive reaction, and where appropriate, adjustment to other parts is evident.

Difficulty levels grid

Depending on how difficult the piece of music performed is, the marks for its difficulty should be applied using this grid. The difficulty level of selected pieces of music can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 1/Level 2 GCSE (9–1) in Music Difficulty levels booklet*, on the Pearson website. These can be used as indicators of the demand of pieces of music and should inform the teacher's judgement in assessing how difficult the pieces performed by the students are. This booklet shows how levels of difficulty can be applied to all instruments for all performances in an accurate and consistent way.

For this GCSE Music qualification, pieces identified as level 4 are identified as 'standard'; above this (level 5 and above) pieces are 'more difficult' and below this (levels 1-3) they are 'less difficult'. Students selecting pieces of music up to difficulty level 2, should be advised that to do so will mean that they are only able to access specific levels and marks in assessment grid 1 (Technique). Pieces at pre-difficulty level 1 are restricted to level 1 of the assessment grid. Pieces at difficulty level 1 are restricted to level 2 of the assessment grid and pieces at difficulty level 2 are restricted to level 3 of the assessment grid. Pieces at difficulty level 3 and above can access the complete grid.

Specific examples of difficulty levels for ensemble performances are not provided in the booklet. In all cases the difficulty level for ensemble performances must be decided by directly comparing the student's part with the examples for solo performance provided and looking for an equivalent level.

Where instruments other than those listed in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 1/Level 2 GCSE (9–1) in Music Difficulty levels booklet* are presented (such as non-GME instruments, e.g. sitar), its difficulty level should be assessed at a comparable level of demand with GME instruments.

Where there is no tradition of graded examinations for the instrument presented, the difficulty level should be assessed at a comparable demand. For example:

Beatboxing will be less difficult if it involves a simple rhythmic idea maintained with basic drum-kit sounds at a steady beat. To achieve standard level it would need two or more of the following:

- Fills with alternative sounds
- Syncopated rhythmic ideas
- Dynamic contrasts
- A fast tempo
- A piece with contrasting sections.

More difficult pieces will be fast, include syncopation, make use of effects such as echo or reverb, and include a wide range of imaginative sounds, including mimicry of standard instruments and scratching effects.

Rapping will be less difficult if it has a single simple rhythmic idea, a steady beat and simple rhymes. To achieve standard level it would need two or more of the following:

- A sung hook
- Syncopated rhythms, including breaks
- Dynamic contrasts
- A fast tempo making greater demands of articulation
- A piece with contrasting sections.

More difficult pieces will always be fast, requiring control of articulation, and make use of syncopation. They will always have a sung hook.

When performing a live solo line over a pre-recorded/sequenced backing track, the level of difficulty is assessed on the live part performed only.

When assessing students' performances, teachers must take the raw mark (the total from the three performance assessment grids out of 24 marks) and decide which level of difficulty the piece performed was. The number in the corresponding difficulty level column will provide the total mark (out of 30) for the performance.

This approach should be used to obtain the marks for both students' solo and ensemble performances. These marks will be combined to produce a final total mark out of 60 for this component.

If a student has chosen to perform more than one piece of music for either their solo or ensemble performance, the teacher assessing must apply a difficulty level to the whole performance based on an average, although taking into consideration the relative length of pieces where these lengths are unbalanced.

Raw mark	Less difficult	Standard	More difficult
1	1	1	2
2	2	3	3
3	3	4	5
4	4	5	6
5	5	6	8
6	6	8	9
7	7	9	11
8	8	10	12

Raw mark	Less difficult	Standard	More difficult
11	11	14	17
12	12	15	18
13	13	16	20
14	14	18	21
15	15	19	23
16	16	20	24
17	17	21	26
18	18	23	27
19	19	24	29
20	20	25	30
21	21	26	30
22	22	28	30
23	23	29	30
24	24	30	30

Security and backups

It is the centre's responsibility to keep the work that students have submitted for assessment secure.

Secure storage is defined as a securely-locked cabinet or cupboard. Where students are producing work, secure storage is defined as a classroom studio or workshop that is locked or supervised from the end of one session to the start of the next.

For materials stored electronically, centres are strongly advised to utilise firewall protection and virus-checking software, and to employ an effective backup strategy, so that an up-to-date archive of students' evidence is maintained.

Further information

For up-to-date advice on teacher involvement and administration of non-examination assessments, please refer to the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) document *Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments (new GCE and GCSE specifications)* available on the JCQ website: www.jcq.org.uk

Component 2: Composing

Overview

The purpose of this component is to assess students' skills in composing music and enables them to appreciate the process of creating music. Students will be introduced to the technical and creative skills required by a composer.

Composing is the creative process by which most of the music we experience came into being. Students will be encouraged to explore a range of compositional starting points and investigate a range of elements, techniques and resources for developing and manipulating ideas – and turning them into completed pieces of music.

Students can also explore the skills needed to compose music for different instrumental and/or vocal forces.

Students must submit two compositions, of a combined duration of at least three minutes:

- one in response to a brief set by Pearson, of at least one minute in duration
- one free composition set by the student, of at least one minute in duration
- students do not have to perform the music that they have composed.

Content

Students should be given a wide range of opportunities to develop their composition skills. Students should take into account the effect of the purpose and intention of their pieces of music, and the effect of audience, time and place when composing their pieces.

Students will be required to demonstrate the ability to:

- make use of musical elements, techniques and resources to create and develop musical ideas with technical control and coherence; freely as the composer chooses, and responding to a brief or commission supplied by others
- compose music that develops musical ideas, uses conventions, and explores the potential of musical structures and resources.

The composition skills to study include:

- Developing musical ideas:
 - developing musical ideas in the form of compositions and/or arrangements.
- Compositional techniques and strategies:
 - how to write for instrument(s) and/or voice(s) and/or technology: efficient, sensitive and idiomatic handling of appropriate timbres and textures
 - how to develop musical ideas within chosen forms and structures: understanding the principles of rhythmic, melodic and harmonic construction and the working of form(s) and structure(s) appropriate to the composition undertaken.
- Ensuring technical control and coherence:
 - working to a set brief: developing the necessary technical skills to meet the requirements of the brief and relating it to its intended audience and occasion.
- Methods of notating composition scores, including:
 - staff notation
 - graphic notation
 - written accounts.

In order to compose in a particular style or genre, it is essential to study examples of music in some detail. This will enable students to recognise and use appropriate musical vocabulary, chord symbols and rhythmic notation relevant to their compositions. Much of the listening and appraising work will involve analysis of the set works and these could be used as models for composing in those particular forms and styles.

Composing using music technology

Students may compose their pieces of music using music technology. This may involve the use of a Digital Audio Workstation (DAW) to compose, edit and process sequenced compositions using live recordings, audio samples and MIDI materials. It may also involve the use of synthesisers, virtual instruments and amplified instruments, such as guitars using pedals (including loop pedals) and other processors.

Musical elements

Depending on the choice of instrument(s) and/or voice(s), and the composition, students should use the appropriate musical elements in their composition.

The musical elements are listed below:

- organisation of pitch
- tonality
- structure
- sonority
- texture
- tempo, metre and rhythm
- dynamics.

Musical contexts

Students should take into account the effect of the purpose and intention of their composition, and the effect of audience, time and place when composing their pieces. Students should compose their music with control, expressing the music as appropriate to its style and mood.

Musical language

Depending on the choice of instrument(s) and/or voice(s), and the composition, students should be able to compose music using the appropriate musical language.

The different types of musical language are listed below:

- reading and writing of staff notation
- major and minor chords and associated chord symbols
- recognising and accurately using appropriate musical vocabulary and terminology related to the areas of study.

The composition briefs

Briefs will be released on the 1st of September for assessment in the following exam series. The briefs will relate to each of the areas of study. The general themes of the briefs are listed below. Each brief will relate to a specific audience and/or occasion. Students must compose to their chosen brief based on one of the areas of study.

The composition may be for any instrument or voice, or combination of instruments and/or voices, and in any style, subject to the requirements of the selected composition brief.

Brief 1 – Instrumental Music 1700-1820

Students should study instrumental forms which facilitate the development and extension of an opening melody such as binary form, ternary, rondo, theme and variations and fantasia. They should practise harmonising and developing given melodies using the techniques of repetition, variation, extension and motivic working to sustain a piece with a varied and creative musical outcome.

Students may work in any style, subject to the brief.

Students will be required to develop a given melodic phrase into a piece for one instrument and accompaniment.

Brief 2 – Vocal Music

Students should investigate the relationship between the structure of vocal pieces and the structure of texts by studying a variety of song forms (for example da capo, strophic, verse/chorus) and word settings. They should investigate the handling of instrumental accompaniments and/or backings.

Students may work in any style, subject to the brief.

Students will be required to set words to music for voice and accompaniment.

Brief 3 – Music for Stage and Screen

Students should study the techniques of underscoring moving images and composing incidental music for the stage to produce a satisfying and flowing succession of musical moods and atmospheres. They should learn how to enhance visual or dramatic action in which the narrative and sequencing may not follow conventional forms and structures. If they choose to compose a show song they should learn how music, lyrics, and if appropriate, dance, combine to produce a theatrical result.

Students may work in any style, subject to the brief.

Students will be required to compose a musical soundtrack in response to a given scenario.

Brief 4 – Fusions

Students should learn how harmony, melody, rhythm and instrumentation combine to create a characteristic stylistic 'feel' in the music. They should gain practice in the handling of these elements to create music in a range of styles and stylistic influences.

Students will be required to compose a piece based on two set musical styles or traditions.

The composition briefs will make compositional demands in terms of the treatment of ideas, techniques and structures but between them will be sufficiently open-ended to allow students the freedom to work in any style or genre or for any instrument.

Students should be aware of the specific assessment criteria against which the compositions will be marked.

Free composition

Students will produce one composition that is free, i.e. not related to a set brief. They should use their imagination and skills to compose a piece of music. They can draw inspiration or starting points from the set works and suggested wider listening, as well as their own interests and the world around them. They should consider the role of the audience and/or occasion in their composition.

The piece composed by the students may be for any instrument or voice, or combination of instruments and/or voices, and in any style.

Assessment information

- First assessment: 2018.
- This component consists of 60 marks.
- Students must submit two compositions, of a combined duration of at least three minutes. One in response to a brief set by Pearson, of at least one minute in duration, and one free composition set by the student, of at least one minute in duration.
- For compositions that **do not** meet the total minimum time requirement, the total composition mark will be reduced proportionally according to how many seconds the combined composition is less than three minutes. This will be applied by Pearson during the moderation process. Please see *Appendix 9: Mark penalty tables for submissions not meeting the minimum assessment time*.
- Four briefs will be published on the Pearson website on the 1st September each year, from September 2017.
- The composing may take place over multiple sessions.
- Compositions must be submitted at the end of the course by 15 May.
- Centres must ensure that compositions submitted are valid for the series in which they are submitted.
- Students must complete a minimum of five hours of their composing, including the final write-up and recording, in a classroom setting under teacher supervision
- Students do not have to perform the pieces of music that they have composed.

Composition task setting, taking and assessment

Task setting

Students should choose the composition brief from those released by Pearson each year, and decide their free composition with the support of their teacher.

Group compositions where the music is the work of more than one student are not acceptable.

Each composition must be at least one minute in duration. The two compositions combined should be a minimum of at least three minutes in duration.

Set brief compositions must be worked on and assessed in the academic year in which the student expects to be awarded the qualification. Free compositions can be worked on at any point, but must be recorded and assessed in the academic year in which the student expects to be awarded the qualification.

Guided maximum composition times

There is no maximum time limit to students' combined composition. Excessively long submissions may be self-penalising.

The guided maximum time for the combined composition (both set brief and free composition) is five minutes. Compositions exceeding the maximum time will still be marked.

Task taking

Students must submit two compositions, of a combined duration of at least three minutes:

- one in response to a brief set by Pearson, of at least one minute in duration
- one free composition set by the student, of at least one minute in duration.

Collaboration

Students may work together on their research but group compositions are not allowed.

While research and development may be carried out by the student in or out of the centre, the final composition and score or account must be completed in the centre under teacher supervision.

Controlled conditions

Students must work on their compositions under controlled conditions for at least five hours. This must include the final write-up of their compositions, and can include any research and development time. The final write-up is defined as the time when the final recording and score or commentary of the piece is produced.

As composition is a creative process that cannot be confined to the classroom, students will be allowed to research and generate initial ideas outside of the classroom and teacher supervision. However to ensure the composition is the student's own unaided, personal and independent work, teachers must monitor and authenticate preparatory work (development of composition ideas, for example this may involve listening to other music, mulling over a brief, experimenting with suitable melodies or rhythmic ideas on guitar or piano, working out rough drafts) prior to the commencement of the composition recording period. Students will be allowed to bring in stimulus and ideas but need to develop ideas within a classroom setting and complete the final recording and write-up under controlled conditions.

Teachers should inspect the preparatory material, and be satisfied that they are the student's own work, checking them against the student's previous work and expectations of them.

Teacher guidance during this period must be restricted to: the availability and suitability of sources and materials, the prevention of plagiarism and ensuring the work is conducted in accordance with specification requirements and procedures.

Feedback

Teachers may help students to understand rubrics, assessment criteria and controls.

Teachers must not provide students with solutions. Any additional feedback must be recorded on the Composition Authentication Sheet, please see *Appendix 2*.

Resources

Students must have equal access to IT resources. Students should have access to a range of resources/interpretations/texts to enable them to make choices as required for their tasks.

Composition recording

Recording the composition

Compositions and arrangements may be realised through conventional instruments or music technology. The quality of the recording of the performance will not be assessed. Only the actual composition itself will be assessed.

Items for submission for moderation

1. Score

A detailed notated score appropriate to the style of music must be submitted for each composition. This can be submitted on manuscript paper or as a printout. The score may be handwritten or printed. This must be produced by the student.

'Score' refers to any of the following: a full score in conventional staff notation; a lead sheet or chord chart; track sheets; written account, tables or diagrams.

The purpose of the score is to justify the intentions of the piece of music that has been composed, so that it may be easily replicated by another performer. It should include all necessary and appropriate musical vocabulary.

Students not enclosing a traditional notation score must submit a written account instead (no more than 500 words). This piece of writing should give a detailed description of the composition and its purpose and meaning. It should refer to the musical content throughout.

Written accounts must contain similar information to that found in a score: details of performance indications and the composer's intentions, including the appropriate and necessary musical vocabulary. A good account containing sufficient information for a realisation of the composer's intentions is acceptable for any style of music.

Whatever format or combination of formats is chosen, the presentation must be sufficiently clear and detailed enough for the moderator to be able to assess the composition or arrangement.

The recording and the score will be used together to assess the composition. The presentation of the score will not carry marks, but students should ensure that it is of sufficient clarity to be read and understood by a third party.

2. Recording

A complete recording of both pieces must be submitted via the online submission platform LWT. Each composition for each student should be a separate track, individually labelled with their centre number, candidate number and composition title. The recording can be made live or be studio-produced.

3. Composition Authentication Sheet

The Composition Authentication Sheet (CAS) must be completed by the teacher, and signed by the student and teacher, authenticating that the work is the student's own. Please see *Appendix 2*.

4. Submissions not meeting minimum time requirement

The combined composition time of both compositions must be at least three minutes.

Students submitting combined compositions of less than three minutes in length should be marked against the assessment criteria on the following pages.

Centres will be required to notify us of any students who do not meet the minimum time requirement of three minutes.

For compositions that do not meet the minimum time requirement, the total composition mark will be reduced proportionally according to how many seconds the combined composition time is less than three minutes. This will be applied by Pearson during the moderation process. Please see *Appendix 9: Mark penalty tables for submissions not meeting the minimum assessment time*.

If, during the moderation process, inaccuracies in the composition times are discovered, the moderator may request the rest of the cohort to verify the correct timings.

Failure to accurately record the composition times may result in staff/centre malpractice. For further information about this, please see the *Administration and general information* section in this specification.

Gaps between pieces and tuning **do not** count towards the composition time.

Marking, standardisation and moderation

Teachers should mark the assignment using the assessment criteria on the following pages. Teachers may annotate students' work but should also include any comments on the Composition Authentication Sheet to justify the marks awarded.

Where marking has been carried out by more than one teacher in a centre, there must be a process of internal standardisation carried out to ensure that there is a consistent application of the assessment criteria.

Marks awarded by the centre will be subject to external moderation by Pearson. Moderation will ensure consistency with national standards. Pearson will notify centres of the students whose work has been selected for moderation. This sample will take cohort size into account.

If the moderation indicates that centre assessment does not reflect national standards, an adjustment will be made to students' final marks to compensate.

For up-to-date advice on teacher involvement and administration of non-examination assessments, please refer to the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) document *Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments (new GCE and GCSE specifications)* available on the JCQ website: www.jcq.org.uk

Composition assessment criteria

Teachers must mark students' compositions using the three assessment criteria grids on the following pages to give a mark out of 30.

These criteria have been developed to assess students' skills in developing musical ideas, demonstrating technical control and composing with musical coherence. They are to be used to assess both the Pearson set brief and free composition.

Where the word 'instrument' is mentioned this includes voice.

For the composition being assessed, teachers should use their professional judgement to establish in which level of quality of the music composed is.

The compositions are equally weighted and will be marked equally, even if the two compositions are of significantly different lengths.

Teachers should mark the compositions against each grid in order to get a total mark out of 30 for each composition (Pearson set brief and free composition). The totals from each composition piece should be added together to give the total marks for this component out of 60.

Composition assessment grid 1: Developing musical ideas

These marks are awarded for the development of musical ideas and use of musical elements as appropriate, the management of stylistic characteristics and conventions, and the response to the brief if appropriate, and the effectiveness with which the piece meets its intended purpose and/or audience.

Level	Mark	Developing musical ideas
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–2	• Musical ideas are limited, undeveloped and have little relevance to the intended purpose and/or audience. • Characteristics and conventions for the chosen genre/style have not been observed or are seriously misjudged. • For brief-set composition only: unimaginative and inappropriate response to the brief.
Level 2	3–4	• Musical ideas are somewhat developed, with some relevance to the intended purpose and/or audience, but with some obtrusive misjudgements that compromise the effectiveness of the piece. • There is an attempt to develop and manage appropriate stylistic characteristics and conventions for the chosen genre/style but these are unconvincing for the most part and maintained inconsistently. • For brief-set composition only: the piece meets the brief in some respects but lacks sophistication and/or detail.
Level 3	5–6	• Musical ideas are developed and extended, with relevance to the intended purpose and/or audience but there are one or two obvious misjudgements and/or inconsistencies. • Stylistic characteristics and conventions for the chosen genre/style have been selected appropriately and are maintained inconsistently in parts but misjudgements do not detract seriously from the overall impression. • For brief-set composition only: the piece meets the brief and its intended audience and occasion although the approach is perhaps a little functional.

Level	Mark	Developing musical ideas
Level 4	7–8	• Musical ideas are developed and extended effectively, with good relevance to the intended purpose and/or audience for the most part. • Stylistic characteristics and conventions for the chosen genre/style have been selected appropriately and maintained convincingly for some of the piece despite one or two minor misjudgements. • For brief-set composition only: creative response to the brief with some sense of audience and occasion.
Level 5	9–10	• Musical ideas are developed and extended successfully and with assurance, meeting the intended purpose and/or audience appropriately. • Stylistic characteristics and conventions for the chosen genre/style have been selected appropriately and handled convincingly throughout. • For brief-set composition only: imaginative response to the brief with a well-developed sense of audience and occasion.

Composition assessment grid 2: Demonstrating technical control

These marks are awarded for control of the appropriate musical elements, of devices and conventions appropriate to the chosen style and/or genre, and of the control of the chosen instrument(s).

Level	Mark	Demonstrating technical control
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–2	• The control of appropriate musical elements is insecure, with many obtrusive misjudgements that seriously compromise the effectiveness of the piece. • The instrumental and/or vocal forces are handled un-idiomatically, possibly with passages that cannot be played/sung. • Textures are narrow in scope and unvaried.
Level 2	3–4	• The control of appropriate musical elements is insecure and marred by obvious and/or frequent misjudgements. • The handling of instrumental and/or vocal forces is functional and basic although the parts are mainly playable/singable. • The handling of textures may be misjudged and/or unvaried.
Level 3	5–6	• The control of appropriate musical elements is mostly secure although there may be some obvious inconsistencies and/or misjudgements. • There is some attempt to write idiomatically for the instrumental and/or vocal forces but they may lack exploitation in parts. • There are no serious misjudgements in the handling of textures but they may lack variety.
Level 4	7–8	• The control of appropriate musical elements is secure, and any misjudgements are not enough to have a serious impact on the success of the piece. • The instrumental and/or vocal forces show some contrast and exploitation. • Textures are varied and clear as appropriate to the style.

Level	Mark	Demonstrating technical control
Level 5	9–10	• The control of appropriate musical elements is secure throughout, and any misjudgements are marginal and few, if any. • The instrumental and/or vocal forces are handled idiomatically and exploited imaginatively. • Textures are varied, complex, and/or clear as appropriate to the style.

Composition assessment grid 3: Composing with musical coherence

These marks are awarded for the use and combination of appropriate musical elements to achieve musical coherence and fluency.

Level	Mark	Composing with musical coherence
	0	No rewardable material
Level 1	1–2	• Little sense of structure, design or balance between the sections. • Limited sense of fluency or contrast in the piece. • The piece may be incomplete or missing significant passages.
Level 2	3–4	• An attempt at basic, balanced structures but perhaps repetitive, predictable or showing too great a diversity of ideas. • Fluency and contrast will be attempted but unconvincing in parts. • There are attempts made at achieving a sense of direction in the piece.
Level 3	5–6	• The piece demonstrates a satisfactory use of basic structures but these may be formulaic or standard forms. • Fluency and contrast will be maintained for the most part. • There is a sense of direction in the piece.
Level 4	7–8	• The piece demonstrates some sense of wholeness and balance between the sections. • There is good sense of fluency and contrast. • There is a good sense of direction overall.
Level 5	9–10	• A sense of coherence and wholeness is achieved throughout. • There is a consistent sense of fluency and contrast throughout. • There is a convincing sense of direction overall.

Security and backups

It is the centre's responsibility to ensure that the composition briefs are kept secure until released to students.

It is also the centre's responsibility to keep the work that students have submitted for assessment secure. Secure storage is defined as a securely-locked cabinet or cupboard.

The rules on storage also apply to electronic data. For example, centres should collect memory sticks for secure storage between sessions or restrict student access to specific areas of the centre's IT network.

For materials stored electronically, centres are strongly advised to utilise firewall protection and virus-checking software, and to employ an effective backup strategy, so that an up-to-date archive of students' evidence is maintained.

Further information

For up-to-date advice on teacher involvement and administration of non-examination assessments, please refer to the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) document *Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments (new GCE and GCSE specifications)* available on the JCQ website: www.jcq.org.uk